

Filing in an Existing Case

A registered filer can file to an existing case after it has been created or converted from paper to electronic format. A document can be filed in multiple cases at one time, but the document *must* include all of the applicable case numbers.

1. On the Home page, click **Existing Case**.

Find the case

Find the case in the Existing Case List

If you have filed on the case before, it will display in the list at the bottom of the Existing Case screen.

1. To sort the case list by title, case number, case type, county, or defendant name (criminal cases only), click that column heading.
2. To search the case list, click **Search My Cases**, and enter the case number, county, and any participant's name.
3. Click the blue link in the Case Title column to file on the case. Skip to the [Add Documents section](#) below.

Note: You can sort the list by clicking on a column heading.

Search for the case

If your case is not on the list, use the case search at the top of the screen to find the case.

1. Select the county in which the case was filed.
2. Enter the case number.
3. Enter the last name of a participant.

If the case does not display, try these solutions:

- Check the spelling of the participant's last name. If the name contains special characters or spaces, see [Entering Party Names](#) or call the clerk of court to determine how to enter the last name.
- If you are not already associated with the case, file a Notice of Case Association on the case. For instructions, see [Associating Yourself with a Case](#).

File on one or more cases

1. If you are filing in only one case, click **File on this case**. Skip to the [Add Documents](#) section below.
2. If you are filing in multiple cases:
 - a. Click **Add this case to your list** for each case. After you add the cases, they will be displayed at the top of the page.
 - b. Verify the cases are correct, and then click **File on These Cases**.

Note: If you add a case in error, click **Remove** to delete the case from the list.

Add Documents

1. Document Category (optional). Select the type of document to be added to the case. (Selecting a category shortens the list of Document Types to choose from.)
2. Document Type. Select the type from the list. To filter the list, type the first letter of the document type.
3. Additional Text (optional). Type any information that will help the clerk, judge, or other participants understand more about the document.
4. Filed under order to restrict access (optional). If you are filing a document under an order that restricts access to the document, select the checkbox and enter the date of the order.

Note: If you are filing a document that is automatically restricted per court rule or Iowa code, you do not have to check the box. To determine if the document is automatically restricted, see the list of [Restricted Documents and Case Types](#).

5. Click **Choose File** and navigate to the document to attach.
6. Click **Open** in the system window (not illustrated).
7. Click **Add**.
8. Verify the document is appropriately loaded by clicking the file name in the View Document column.

Note: If the file did not load properly, remove it by clicking the icon in the Remove column.

9. Repeat steps 1 through 8 to add any additional documents.
10. Click **Next**.
11. On the Review and Approve Filing page, verify all information being submitted to the case is accurate and complete.
12. Optional actions:
 - a. If you need to add or remove documents, click **Add/Remove Documents**.
 - b. If your filing involves property that must be listed on Lis Pendens, click Add **Real Estate**, and add property details.
 - c. If you need to add or remove parties, click **Add Parties**.
 - d. Add special filing instructions for the court (not illustrated).

Note: If applicable, complete the Payment Information.

13. Click **Submit the Filing**. Your submitted document(s) will receive a file stamp at the time our computer system receives them.

When your document has been filed with the court, you will receive a confirmation and a status update in your My Filings page.

This information is for instructional purposes only and is not intended to and does not constitute legal advice under any circumstance.